

eat with the blood, and lift up your eyes toward your idols,
 26 and shed blood: and shall ye possess the land? Ye stand
 upon your sword, ye work abomination, and ye defile every
 one his neighbour's wife: and shall ye possess the land?
 27 Say thou thus unto them, Thus saith the Lord God; *As*
 I live, surely *they* that *are* in the wastes shall fall by the
 sword, and him that *is* in the open field will I give to the
 beasts to be devoured, and *they* that *be* in the forts and in
 28 the caves shall die of the pestilence. For I will lay the
 land most desolate, and the pomp of her strength shall
 cease; and the mountains of Israel shall be desolate, that

ye eat with the blood] i.e. eat flesh slaughtered in such a way that the blood remains in it. According to the law animals had to be slaughtered in such a way as to drain away the blood, which was poured into the ground, where not dashed upon the altar. An example of a prohibited way of slaughtering was breaking the neck, Is. lxvi. 3. Cf. Lev. xvii. 10, xix. 26; Deut. xii. 16; 1 Sam. xiv. 32. See on xviii. 6, 11, 15, xxii. 9.

lift up your eyes] See xviii. 6. On "shed blood" xxii. 6, 9.

26. *stand upon your sword*] Hardly means, the footing on which ye deal with men is the sword; but probably, ye occupy yourselves with the sword, cf. xlv. 24.

work abomination] The term is mostly applied to religious practices contrary to the pure religion of Jehovah. On the other sin named cf. xviii. 6, xxii. 11. Verses 25, 26 are wanting in LXX. The passage is vigorous and apart from the anomalous form "ye work" (where *fem. n* is due to following *t*) altogether unsuspicious. The omission in LXX. may have arisen from the eye of the translator straying from the words "Lord God" *v.* 25 to the same words *v.* 27.

27. The "wastes" are the desolate cities; those that still hover about these ruins shall be slain by the enemy. The "open field" is the country, now depopulated and "the possession of wild beasts;" and the "forts," coupled with caves, are the natural fastnesses of the land. Those taking refuge there shall die of the pestilence, due to crowding and famine. The remnant shall be exterminated from the land.

28. Cf. vii. 24, xxiv. 21, xxx. 6, 7. The "mountains of Israel" are the mountain land of Israel.

30—33. Demeanour of the people towards the prophet.

The confirmation which the fall of the city gave to the prophet's past predictions awakened the interest of his fellow exiles in him and his words. They congregated together in knots under the shadow of the walls and in the doors of the houses discussing his sayings. Recent events had given him a more prominent place in their thoughts. There